

Exercise: Supply Chain Fundamentals

CASE STUDY QUESTIONS & GROUP TASKS

Based on the INSEAD case study “*Supply Chain Hubs in Global Humanitarian Logistics*”, each group must prepare a presentation and submit a structured report (max 3,500 words) addressing the following:

Students are encouraged to complement the case study with additional academic literature, humanitarian reports, and real-world examples to strengthen their analysis.

1. Supply Chain Network Design & Performance Trade-offs

Analyse and compare:

- Centralized (single global hub)
- Decentralized (multiple regional hubs)
- Hybrid models (including temporary hubs)

Key dimensions

- Response time
- Cost structure (fixed vs. variable)
- Flexibility under uncertainty
- Inventory pooling effects

Use simulation data (costs, number of hubs, transport, expediting) to support your analysis.

Key question

How do different network configurations balance cost efficiency and responsiveness under varying disaster scenarios?

2. Demand Segmentation & Supply Chain Strategy Alignment

Analyse the three demand types:

- Development programs
- Minor disasters
- Mega disasters

Compare

- Planning horizon
- Cost sensitivity
- Required responsiveness
- Implications for network design

Key question

How should humanitarian supply chains be structured to simultaneously serve stable and highly unpredictable demand?

3. Operational Constraints & Feasibility of Supply Chain Design

Assess:

- Temporary hubs as a strategic option
- Real-world constraints:
 - Funding (earmarked vs. flexible)
 - Infrastructure limitations
 - Regulatory barriers
 - Coordination challenges

Evaluate

- Feasibility of temporary hubs in different contexts
- Impact on response time (especially early disaster phase)
- Operational risks and trade-offs

Key question

To what extent are theoretically optimal supply chain designs constrained by real-world operational conditions?

4. Strategic Synthesis & Recommendations

Propose a **recommended supply chain configuration** for the organization.

Must include

- Number and positioning of hubs
- Role of temporary hubs
- Approach to different demand types
- Balance between cost and responsiveness

Differentiate

- Short-term operational improvements
- Long-term strategic transformation

Justification

- Case data (simulation, exhibits)
- External references

Key question

What is the most robust and adaptive supply chain strategy for future humanitarian operations?

DELIVERABLES & SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

Format and Submission

- Groups of **4-5 students max**
- **Presentation:** Max 30 minutes (all group members must participate)
- **Group report:** Max 3,500 words (excluding references)
- Include **visuals, tables, and diagrams** (e.g., supply chain maps, cost comparisons)

Task	Deadline	Notes
Group Report + Presentation Submission	18th May 12:00	Submission via email
Group Presentation	20th May 18:00	Online / in class
Feedback Session	27th May 18:00	Interactive discussion

Grading

The assignment consists of two components:

- **Group Presentation (40%)**
- **Written Report (60%)**

Evaluation Criteria:

- Depth of supply chain analysis
- Ability to apply theory to humanitarian context
- Use of data and evidence (case + external sources)
- Quality and feasibility of recommendations
- Clarity, structure, and professionalism